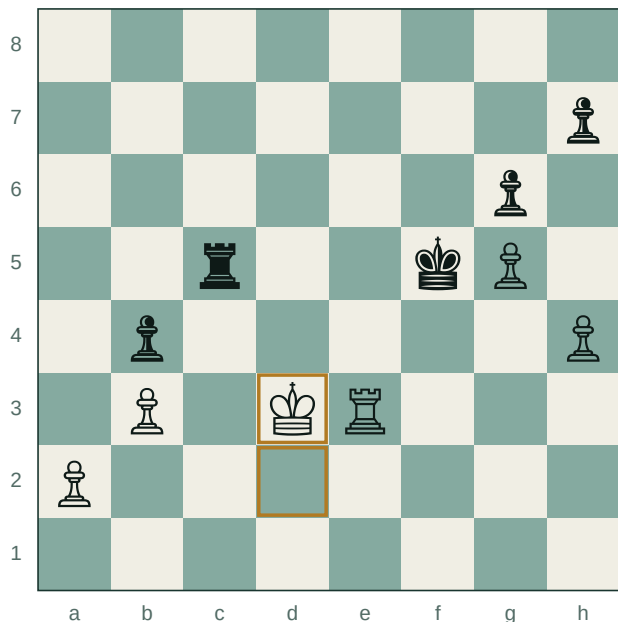


Rook-ending tactics: Black, move 60

Rook-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 60.Kd3. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

60...Rc3+ 61. Kd4 Rxe3 62. Kxe3 Kg4 63. Kd2 Kxh4 64. a3 bxa3

60...Rc3+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **61.Kd4**.

61...Rxe3 The rook captures the rook on e3. Recorded reply: **62.Kxe3**.

62...Kg4 The king moves from f5 to g4. Recorded reply: **63.Kd2**.

63...Kxh4 The king captures the pawn on h4. Recorded reply: **64.a3**.

64...bxa3 The pawn captures the pawn on a3.

At the end, nominal material is White 2 / Black 3 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +2. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +2:** the balance goes from -1 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

HOW TO LOOK

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on d3. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.